APEX INTERNATIONAL ACADEMY

CBSE Senior Secondary Affiliation No. 1930482 | Academic Excellence & Research Division

OFFICIAL ACADEMIC SOLUTION & EVALUATION DOSSIER

VERIFIED & GRADED

ASSIGNMENT: Ancient Indus Valley Civilization Report

SUBJECT: Social Studies (SST101)

CLASS & SECTION: Class 6 - Section A

ACADEMIC YEAR: 2025 - 2026

MARKS EVALUATED: 88 / 100 (Grade A)

TEACHER DIRECTIVE & PROBLEM FOCUS:
Summary of Harappa urban planning, granaries, and drainage system with archaeological significance.

1. Executive Overview & Problem Context

The Indus Valley Civilization (c. 2600 – 1900 BCE), also designated as the Harappan Civilization, represents one of the earliest urbanized societies in human antiquity. Centered across the fertile floodplains of the Indus and Ghaggar-Hakra river systems in northwestern South Asia, the civilization exhibited remarkable architectural sophistication, rigorous municipal standardization, and highly organized urban infrastructure that surpassed many contemporary Bronze Age civilizations.

2. Core Analysis, Solutions & Systematic Working

- **Grid Urban Town Planning & Brick Masonry:**

  Harappan cities like Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa were divided systematically into two main sectors: the elevated Citadel (Western Sector) and the Lower Town (Eastern Sector). Streets were oriented precisely along cardinal directions in a gridiron pattern, intersecting at 90-degree right angles. Domestic and civic structures were constructed with kiln-baked bricks conforming to a standardized dimensional ratio of 4:2:1 (length:width:thickness).

- **Advanced Hydraulic Engineering & Drainage:**

  Every residential home was equipped with a dedicated brick-paved bathroom and wastewater chute that fed into covered street drains. Main drains were shielded with removable limestone inspection slabs, allowing regular municipal desilting. Sump pits and soak-wells captured silt before runoff discharged outside the city walls, preventing contamination.

- **The Great Bath of Mohenjo-Daro:**

  The Great Bath measures approximately 11.88 meters by 7.01 meters, with a depth of 2.43 meters. It was rendered completely watertight through a double layer of tightly fitted baked bricks, bonded by gypsum mortar and backed by a thick seal of natural bitumen (asphalt), demonstrating pioneering waterproofing technology intended for ceremonial purification rituals.

- **Granaries & Grain Storage Infrastructure:**

  The Great Granary at Harappa consisted of twelve separate storage chambers arranged in two rows of six, mounted upon raised brick platforms with air-duct ventilation channels beneath the floorboards to protect stored barley and wheat against dampness, pests, and flooding.

- **Economic Trade, Steatite Seals & Standardization:**

  Harappans engaged in extensive maritime and overland commerce with ancient Mesopotamia (referred to as Meluhha in cuneiform texts). Trade was regulated through standardized chert cubic weights and distinctive square steatite seals depicting the unicorn, zebu bull, and the enigmatic proto-Shiva Pashupati figure.

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3. Detailed Data Matrix & Systematic Findings

Archaeological Site	Key Discoveries	River Basin	Significance
Harappa	Great Granary, Coffin Burials, Terracotta Figurines	Ravi River	First site discovered (1921)
Mohenjo-Daro	Great Bath, Bronze Dancing Girl, Priest-King	Indus River	Largest urban metropolis
Lothal	Tidal Dockyard, Bead Factory, Rice Husk relics	Bhogava River	Premier maritime port hub
Kalibangan	Ploughed Field surface, Fire Altars, Camel bones	Ghaggar River	Early agricultural proof
Dholavira	Giant Stone Water Reservoirs, Inscription Signboard	Rann of Kutch	Master hydraulic system

4. Student Conclusions & Reflective Synthesis

The Harappan civilization stands as an unparalleled testament to sustainable civic engineering, peaceful municipal administration, and egalitarian urban living. Its sudden decline around 1900 BCE highlights the vulnerability of riverine civilizations to hydrological changes and climate shifts, offering enduring lessons for modern urban planning.

5. Official Faculty Evaluation & Grading Rubric

ASSESSMENT CRITERIA BREAKDOWN

Conceptual Clarity & Factual Accuracy:	**28 / 30**	**Problem Solving & Structured Working:**	**18 / 20**
Analytical Depth & Research Methodology:	**28 / 30**	**Presentation, Organization & Neatness:**	**14 / 20**

FACULTY FEEDBACK REMARK:

"Very good effort. Clear and organized historical analysis of Harappan architecture and drainage."

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